



SHASHIKUMAR THIMMAIAH: THE RICE DOCTOR

Every grain of rice undergoes many transformations before it lands up in our plates. Shashikumar Thimmaiah's APIT Group uses cutting edge modern technology to ensure that each grain conserves its goodness and nourishes us to its optimum.

The Green Revolution of yesteryears was the Indian Agricultural eco-system's savior. It introduced a path-breaking shift in our Agri-practices and how we cultivate our food. In today's fast paced, stressful world, our lifestyle, tastes, and food preferences are changing. This in turn affects our health drastically. There has always been a need to produce quality grains and food products of higher nutritional value, suiting the health and dietary needs of our body. The dramatically changing world has just accelerated this need. Producing high quality Food Grains with higher nutrition has always been the top most agenda for Shashikumar Thimmaiah, Founder & Director of the APIT Group. Fondly referred to as the 'Grain Doctor' by thinkers & leaders in the Agri & Food Tech domain, Thimmaiah has transformed the way food grains are processed, through his brainchild Agri Process Innovations Technology (APIT), which he founded in 2016.

Since then, The APIT Group has grown by leaps and bounds and has metamorphosed into two fast growing companies APIT & APIT Automation, with an excellent track record of over 130+ projects in India & abroad. With world-class, state of the art infrastructure on campus,

its headquarter in Bengaluru is a hub of innovation and revolutionary improvisations. APIT has emerged as the World's Best Regarded Paddy Processing Specialist. APIT Automation are pioneers in providing Automation Technology for Food Processing. The team at APIT firmly believes that their organization is synonymous for being Agile, Pragmatic, Innovative and Transformative with their technology solutions.

The journey of Thimmaiah, also known as SKT Sir in the industry, has been extremely inspiring. A native of Kolar District, Karnataka, he holds a degree in Mechanical Engineering. Starting his career as a charging man with KSRTC, he moved on to address the challenges in Food Tech by working with companies like Milltec Machinery, Agritech Engineering and Rashi Info Solutions. Destiny has bigger plans for him, as he eventually started his own company APIT, creating a revolutionary impact on Grain Processing Methods. The success saga of APIT spreads beyond India to many other countries like Bangladesh, Malaysia, Nigeria, Kenya, Europe, and South Asia. This underlines the critical contribution of Thimmaiah and his team in Paddy processing and the Grain Tech space. Paddy, one of the major food crops of our nation,

undergoes various processes like parboiling, ageing, and drying, before they enter our homes. The legacy methods used till date resulted in non-uniform color consistency, broken grains, inconsistency of quality across batches and an overall disturbed cooking quality. APIT has been solving these challenges through fully automated processes and next gen technology driven by Artificial Intelligence (AI) and Internet of Things (IoT). "The USP of our technology has always been Automation, Digitization and Data Science", says Thimmaiah. The APIT plant can be constructed in minimal time with less investment which can give better returns over extended periods. All the machinery is integrated with modern technology and automated systems. The company has developed a unique gel cook station for producing high quality parboiled paddy. Developed with the inputs from renowned grain scientist, Dr. Kshirod Bhattacharya, these Gel Cook stations ensure uniformity in color, texture, quality, and nutritional value of rice. As they say, "the proof of the pudding is in the eating". The inventions of Thimmaiah and his team in the Food Processing space are surely cooking up a delicious pudding for the Industry and the Consumers.